

PREFERRED POSITION

PLAYER-SET POSITION · THE MISSING PRIMITIVE

P703 · PROPOSAL

The idea — let each player pick a **primary** and **secondary** position from their profile. It's a 30-second action, unlocks position-aware stats and ratings, and gives the balancer the single most important constraint it's missing.

Why now

- **10 of 36 active players have no position set** — the balancer has nothing to work with. Admin-only field, no incentive for players to ask for it.
- **Stats are about to come alive** (Wall, distance, goals/game) — interpreting them without position is misleading. A GK with 1 goal/season is a hero; a striker with 1 goal/season isn't.
- **The 18 Jun draft was lopsided on positions, not ratings** — see below. v2 balancer can't fix this without position data.

Exhibit A · the 18 Jun teams by position

TEAM	GK	DEF	MID	ATT	?	OUTCOME
Aaron Franklin FC	1	2	2	4	0	3W 0D 0L · winners (top-heavy carried)
Gary Edwards FC	0	5	3	0	1	1W 2D 0L · 2 goals in 3 games (no finisher)
Josh Edwards FC	1	0	7	1	0	0W 2D 1L · last (zero defenders)
Mikel Winter FC	1	2	5	0	1	1W 0D 2L · no strikers

The pattern: every team that lost or drew was the wrong **shape**, not the wrong **quality**. Aaron FC won not because they were stronger overall, but because they had 4 strikers vs a team with zero. Today's balancer optimises ratings; this is the shape it can't see.

How it works

Data model

Two new columns on **profiles**:

- **preferred_position_primary** — required for new sign-ups, prompted at first login for existing players
- **preferred_position_secondary** — optional, for the player who's "happy at MID, can fill in at DEF"

Four positions to keep it simple — football people have opinions about CDM vs CAM but a Sunday-night roster doesn't need it:

- **GK** — Goalkeeper
- **DEF** — Defender
- **MID** — Midfielder
- **ATT** — Forward

Player-set, not admin-set

Lives on the **profile page** as a single picker — primary big, secondary smaller. Players see it, players own it. Admin can still nudge ("you've been playing DEF all month, want to update?") via a one-tap prompt on the next-game screen. *

SET YOUR POSITION



Tap once for primary · tap again for secondary · tap a third time to clear.

► What it unlocks

- **Position-aware overall** — defender's "63 ATT" no longer drags their overall down. Each attribute weighted by relevance to the position they actually play.
- **Position-aware leaderboards on Stats** — "Top 3 strikers by goals/game", "Top 3 defenders by Wall", "Top GK by clean sheets %". Specialists finally get celebrated.
- **Balancer constraint** — every team gets ≥ 1 GK, ≥ 1 DEF, ≥ 1 ATT (whenever possible). Soft-balance to ~equal MID counts. The 18 Jun chaos becomes impossible.
- **Secondary position as the safety valve** — if there's only one GK signed up but two players have GK as secondary, balancer pulls one across. No more "Chris Hughes is in goal by default."
- **Form rating context** — peer for a defender who kept a clean sheet means something different from peer for a striker who scored. Weighted by position.

WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE

CARD · STATS · BALANCER

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► The updated player card

Big position badge top-right, secondary small underneath, footer ranks you against your positional peers — the thing players will actually open the app to look at.

9

OVR

ATT

also MID

BEAU SAMUELS

SHO Shooting

10

PAC Pace

10

DRI Dribbling

9

PAS Passing

9

PHY Physical

10

DEF Defence

9

#1 ATT · 14 goals · 0.4 / game

Striker · key stats highlighted

9

OVR

DEF

also MID

LAWRIE POINTER

DEF Defence

9

PHY Physical

10

PAC Pace

10

PAS Passing

9

DRI Dribbling

9

SHO Shooting

7

#1 DEF · 2.50 GA/night · 1 CS

Defender · DEF and PHY emphasised

Subtle but powerful — same overall score (9), different headline stats, different footer pill, different colour scheme. Identity at a glance. Players notice and care.

► New angles on the Stats page

The redesigned Stats page already has hero strips and podiums. Add a fourth hero strip card — **"Top GK"** — and gate three existing panels by position filter:

PANEL	DEFAULT VIEW	WITH POSITION FILTER
Top Scorers	All players ranked	"Top 3 strikers · Top 3 midfielders"
The Wall · GA/night	All eligible	"Top defenders · Top GKs separately"
Distance / Game	All tracked players	Per-position averages — midfielders likely run furthest
Winning Team	By apps	"Who's the most-winning ATT / MID / DEF"

► Balancer impact (positional layer on top of v2)

CONSTRAINT	HARD / SOFT	WHAT IT PREVENTS
≥1 GK per team	Hard (use secondaries if short)	Gary FC's keeperless night
≥1 ATT per team	Hard (use secondaries if short)	Gary FC scoring 2 in 3 games

≥1 DEF per team	Hard (use secondaries if short)	Josh FC's zero-defender chaos
MID count within ±1 across teams	Soft	Josh FC's 7-vs-3 midfield imbalance
Categorical balance (from v2)	Soft	Talent stacking within positions

Combined effect: v2 balancer (categorical) + positions = matches that are fair on both [quality](#) AND [shape](#). The most-realistic improvement on offer.

► Sequencing into the existing roadmap

1. **Position picker on profile** (this proposal) — week 1, low-risk, no rating changes.
2. **One-tap prompt on Next Game** for the 10 players with no position set — week 1, drives adoption.
3. **Stats panels gated by position filter** + 4th hero card for "Top GK" — week 2.
4. **Card redesign** with prominent position badge + position rank pill — week 2.
5. **Balancer v2 with positional constraints** — week 3, ships only once ≥80% of regulars have a position set.
6. **Engagement backlog (push, streaks, social proof) → then peer rating** — separate workstream, runs in parallel.

Lowest-risk · highest-impact addition to the rating + balance roadmap.
30 seconds of player input · unlocks every other improvement.